

KIMONO A Japanese garment of *cotton* or *silk*, full-length and with very wide sleeves, worn crossed over at the front and fastened with an *obi*.

10TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.213, 459

KIMONO SLEEVES Wide sleeves like the sleeves on a *kimono*, cut as part of the *bodice*, with a deep *armscye*.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.48–9, 458

KIRTLE In medieval times a long supportive garment for women, worn over a *smock* but under a *gown*.

10TH CENTURY–c.1650: SEE PP.62–3, 75

KITTEN HEEL On women's shoes, a low heel that tapers sharply inwards at the back, with a very narrow base.

1959 ▷

KNICKERBOCKERS Loose-fitting *breeches*, gathered just below the knee, mainly worn by men for golf and country pursuits.

1860 ▷: SEE PP.217, 226–7, 283

KNIFE PLEATS A series of *pleats* facing in one direction around a garment, as on a *kilt*.

SEE PP.230, 452

KNITTING A method of making fabric by interconnecting loops of *wool* to form a web-like material.

KURTA PAJAMA An outfit, usually of *cotton* or *silk*, worn by Indian men; it comprises a *kurta* (a loose, knee-length shirt with slits up the sides) and *pajama* (lightweight trousers).

SEE P.462

L

LACE (a) A delicate ornamental fabric with a web-like pattern; (b) a cord used to tie garments or shoes, often with *aglets* at each end.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.98–9, 120–2

LAMCHU Indigo-dyed or black collarless *jacket*, with colourful *embroidery* around the neckline, front edges, and sleeve hems; worn by the Dao hill tribe of Southeast Asia.

SEE P.460

LAMÉ A fabric woven with threads of gold- or silver-coloured metal.

1920s ▷: SEE PP.274–5, 291

LAPELS The turned-back folds on the front of a coat or *jacket*.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.153, 263, 301

LAPPETS Pieces of fabric that hang from an indoor headdress, at the sides or the back.

18TH–19TH CENTURY: SEE PP.86, 132, 191



LATCHET Leather strip used to fasten shoes, from the Old French word “*lacet*”, to lace; a latchet shoe has a single lacing; often with open sides.

13TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.104, 142

LAWN A fine, semi-transparent cloth of *linen* or *cotton*.

14TH CENTURY ▷

LEDERHOSEN Traditional leather shorts with braces, worn by men in Alpine areas of Germany and Austria.

SEE P.446

LEGHORN HAT A women's hat with a wide, soft brim, made from Italian Leghorn wheat straw.

EARLY 18TH CENTURY ▷

LEG-OF-MUTTON SLEEVE See *Gigot*.

LEI Garland of fresh flowers worn as decoration in Hawaii and Polynesia; also made from other materials such as bone, shell, and feathers.

c.6TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.463

LEOTARD A stretchy, close-fitting body covering worn by dancers and gymnasts, but also adopted for fashion; see *Beatnik style*.

1880s ▷: SEE PP.217, 388

LE SMOKING A *dinner jacket* or *tuxedo* suit for women, first created by Yves Saint Laurent; see also *Androgynous style*.

LATE 1960s ▷: SEE PP.372–3, 381

LEVI'S® 501 *Jeans* created by the Levi Strauss Co. in 1873 and popularized by US cowboys; in the 1960s they became an icon of rebellious youth; very fashionable in the 1980s, they are widely worn as casual wear.

1873 ▷: SEE P.373

LIBERTY PRINTS Hand-printed designs on Indian *silk*, created by Liberty of London, with floral or *paisley* patterns; now often used on *cotton*; see also *Aesthetic dress*.

1875 ▷: SEE P.237

LINEN A strong, fine fibre made from the stems of the flax plant (*Linum usitatissimum*); one of the oldest woven fabrics in the world.

LINGERIE French for *linen*, used to refer to women's underwear, often made from light, *silky* materials and trimmed with frills or *lace*.

c.1830s ▷: SEE PP.228, 252, 277, 316, 432–3

LINING A thin layer of fabric added to the inside of a garment to cover raw edges and improve comfort.

LIST The *selvedge* of a fabric; “list slippers” were slippers made from strips of selvedge.

18TH–19TH CENTURY

LIVERY Distinctive colours, insignia, or symbols attached to clothes, denoting a person of rank and his or her soldiers or followers; used to identify servants of an aristocratic household.

14TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.84, 117

LOAFERS Slip-on leather shoes like *moccasins*, often with decorative leather strips or tassels on the *vamp*.

1930s ▷: SEE P.419

LODEN A thick, *napped* woollen fabric made in Austria and Germany, used for coats and *jackets* and typically dyed forest-green; also a classic coat made from this fabric, with a long *pleat* at the back.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.227, 446

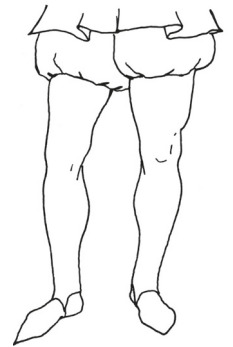
LONG POCKET A vertical pocket on a coat or overcoat.

18TH–19TH CENTURY: SEE P.453

LONG STOCKING

The stocking part of *trunk-hose*, joined to the upper part halfway up the thigh.

16TH–EARLY 17TH CENTURY



LOONS Flared trousers similar to *bell-bottoms* but with a much wider flare from the knees down.

LATE 1960s–EARLY 1970s

LOUNGE SUIT The most common form of suit for men, comprising a *jacket* and trousers (and sometimes a *waistcoat*), and used for day or business wear.

c.1860 ▷: SEE PP.224, 288

LUREX® A brand name for a type of synthetic fibre *yarn* coated with aluminium, or a metallic fabric made with this yarn.

1940s ▷

LYCRA® A brand name for a synthetic fibre with high elasticity, added to fabrics for use in garments such as underwear and swimwear.

1958 ▷: SEE PP.382, 388

M

MACKINTOSH Rubberized *cotton* invented by Charles Mackintosh and used to make coats; now describes any waterproof coat.

1836 ▷: SEE P.356

MADE-TO-MEASURE A term for a garment made from a base pattern but adapted for an individual wearer; see also *Bespoke*, *Ready-to-wear*.

MADRAS Patterned *cotton* or *silk* fabric originally from Madras (now Chennai) in India; sometimes treated to give a lustrous surface.

MAGENTA The second *aniline dye* to be invented, after *mauve*; a pinkish crimson colour.

1860 ▷